

Agricultural Policy and Markets

Computing and Mathematics

May, 2026

Agricultural Policy and Markets (A24741)

Short Title:	Ag Policy and Markets	
Faculty	Science and Computing	
Department	Computing and Mathematics	
Cluster	AgriFoodICT	
Author	ADUNPHY	
Credits	5	Level: Advanced

Description of Module / Aims

The purpose of this module is to study and evaluate the wider economic environment which impinges on the agricultural sector. A diverse range of topics are studied which have a bearing on the economic prospects of the sector and/or influence the contribution of agriculture to wider social and environmental objectives. A review of the important data sources and associated applications is covered.

Programmes

AGRI -0110	HDip in Science in Agri-Food ICT Systems (WD_SAFICT_G)	5 / 1 / M
	Higher Diploma in Science in Agri-Food ICT Systems (WD_18AFICT_G)	1 / 1 / M

Indicative Content

- The contribution of agriculture to the national economy; review of developments in main agricultural enterprises
- Agriculture data sourcing and analysis: Compendium of Agricultural Statistics (Dept of Agriculture, Food and the Marine); National Farm Survey - current and recent trends (Teagasc); Situation and outlook in agriculture - current year (DAFM); Aggregate output, input and incomes - current and recent years (CSO); International data (OECD)
- Principles of agricultural policy: Rationale for support for agriculture; The policy cycle; Alternative support measures; Agriculture as provider of public goods; economic, social and environmental implications
- European Union and the CAP: CAP origins, development and reform; EU agriculture budget and Ireland's contribution; non-market CAP policies and other policies impacting on agriculture
- Delivery of CAP agricultural services online: Pillar 1 - Production: Basic payment scheme, Greening and ecological focus areas; Pillar 2 - Rural Development: Agri-environment(GLAS online); Beef data and genomics programme; Knowledge transfer groups; Targeted applied modernisation scheme(TAMS), General Data Protection Regulation(GDPR)
- International Trade in agricultural products: Current and emerging trade patterns; WTO rules and commitments; Trade conflicts
- Brexit implications for agricultural trade:- UK, Northern Ireland, European Union and Ireland
- Long term trends analysis: Population; incomes; lifestyle/market preferences; environmental protection/energy conservation/global warming

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Appraise current developments in the national and international economic environment.
2. Evaluate the contribution of agriculture to national economic, social and environmental objectives.
3. Critique the key features of agriculture support policy regimes.
4. Assess the implications for agriculture of likely trends emanating from the sector itself or from outside the sector.
5. Source and analyse data relevant to general performance and the agricultural sector in particular.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- This module will be presented by a combination of lectures, guest lectures, practicals and field trips.
- The lectures will be used to introduce new topics and their related concepts while the practicals will reinforce the theory topics and afford the opportunity to engage in assignment work.
- Practical work will also allow for independent research, presentations, peer learning and peer review.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>In-Class Assessment</i>	50%	1,3,5
Final Written Examination	50%	1,2,3,4

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter.

40%-49%: Will be able to show a good knowledge of the key learning outcomes including the contribution that agriculture makes to the Irish economy. The student will be able to source relevant data and present it in the assignment and in the exam.

50%-59%: As well as the above the student will be able to demonstrate a good understanding of agriculture policies and markets in the Irish economy and in the wider EU and world context. The student will be able to source relevant data and present it in a clear manner in the assignment and in the exam.

60%-69%: In addition, the student will demonstrate more detailed knowledge of all the topics including the impact of European and world trade on Irish agriculture. The student will be able to source key data and present it in a clear manner in the assignment and in the exam.

70%-100%: The learner will be able to demonstrate comprehensive knowledge and understanding of all learning outcomes, including the current and future trends in Irish, EU and competitor trading blocks. The student will be able to source key data and present it in a convincing manner in the assignment and in the exam.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	24	24
Practical	12	12
Independent Learning	99	99

Essential Material

- "Dept Agriculture Food and the Marine - Compendium of Agricultural Statistics." Dept Agriculture Food and the Marine. www.irlgov.ie
- Coleman, D. _The Economics of the European Union_. London: Oxford University Press, 2017.
- DAFM. _Department of Agriculture_ _Food and the Marine - Annual review and outlook_ Dublin. 2017.
- Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Food. _Food Harvest 2020_ Dublin. 2010.
- Department of Agriculture, Food and the Marine. _Food Wise 2025_ Dublin. 2015.
- O'Hagan, J. and F. O'Toole. _The economy of Ireland - Policy-Making in a Global Context_. 13th. UK: Palgrave, 2017.
- Teagasc. _National farm Survey_ by Dillon, E., B. Moran and T. Donnellan.. Dublin. 2017.

Supplementary Material

- "Development Co-operation Report 2017." OECD. 17/102017. <http://www.oecd.org/dac/development-co-operation-report-2017/2017102017.htm>
- "WTO Issues Annual report 2018." World Trade Organisation. https://www.wto.org/english/news_e/news18_e/anrp_30may18_e.htm

Requested Resources

- Room Type: Computer Lab